

GNIOT Institute of Management Studies – PGDM (Batch 2024-26)**(TRIMESTER – III) END TERM EXAMINATION, MAY -2025****BUSINESS RESEARCH METHODS***[Time: 2 Hours]**[Maximum Marks: 60]***Following are the course outcomes of the subject: - BUSINESS RESEARCH METHODS**

CO	Course Outcome (CO)
CO1	Understand the research methods for all functional areas of management.
CO2	Design the experiments for management research.
CO3	Analyse the output of experiments for effective decision making.

*(Note- Faculty can add the more CO's as per their subject.)***SECTION-A***Attempt all parts of the following: (Short Answer Type Questions, do not exceed 150- 200 words)*

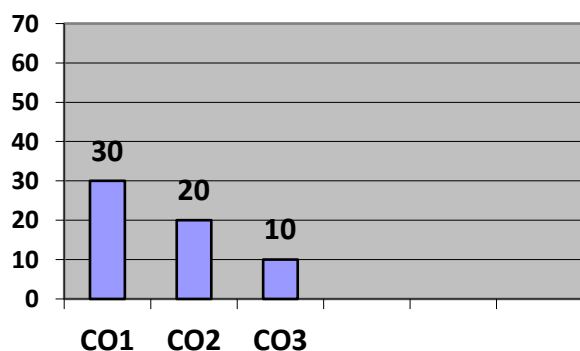
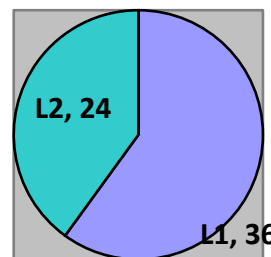
Q.1	Marks	COURSE OUTCOME	BLOOMS LEVEL
(A)	4	CO – 1	BL1
(B)	4	CO – 1	BL1
(C)	4	CO – 1	BL2
(D)	4	CO – 1	BL1
(E)	4	CO – 1	BL2

SECTION-B*Attempt ANY TWO questions out of the following: (Long Answer Type Questions, do not exceed 300- 400 words)*

Q. No	Marks	COURSE OUTCOME	BLOOMS LEVEL
2 (A)	10	CO – 1	BL1
2 (B)	10	CO – 1	BL1
3 (A)	10	CO – 2	BL2
3 (B)	10	CO – 2	BL2

SECTION-C*Attempt all parts of the following: (Caselet / Numerical, do not exceed 300- 400 words)*

Q.4	Marks	COURSE OUTCOME	BLOOMS LEVEL
4 (A)	10	CO – 2	BL2
4 (B)	10	CO - 3	BL1

Course Outcome Wise Marks Distribution**L1 L2****Bloom's Level wise Marks Distribution**

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INSTRUCTIONS:

- (i) There are **THREE** sections in this question paper.
- (ii) Attempt questions from each section as per the directions.
- (iii) Make suitable assumptions wherever necessary.

SECTION-A

(Short Answer Type Questions, do not exceed 200 words)

Q.1. Attempt all parts of the following:

(5×4=20)

- (a) Define Business Research. Explain the features of a good research.
- (b) How can interdisciplinary research between social sciences and business inform more effective organizational strategies and improve decision-making in complex market environments?
- (c) Differentiate between primary data and secondary data with suitable examples.
- (d) Define Research Ethics. Why is ethics important in business research?
- (e) How is a longitudinal study different from a cross-sectional study?

SECTION-B

(Long Answer Type Questions)

Q.2. Attempt all questions of the following

(2X10=20)

- (a) Enumerate the different methods of collecting data. Which one is most suitable for conducting enquiry regarding family welfare program in India? What are its merits and demerits.

OR

- (b) “The task of defining a research problem often follows a sequential pattern.” In light of this statement, briefly Define the different steps involved in a research process.

Q.3. (a) Describe various techniques of sampling in detail.

OR

- (d) Explain the significance of a research report and narrate the various steps involved in writing a research report.

SECTION-C

A multinational clothing retailer noticed a sudden decline in sales in its Southeast Asian markets, particularly among its younger customer segment. The company's management was unsure whether the issue stemmed from product relevance, pricing strategy, marketing communication, or shifting consumer behavior. To address the issue, the company initiated a structured business research project focused on collecting relevant data to identify root causes.

The research team designed a multi-method data collection strategy. First, they distributed digital surveys through email and social media platforms to collect quantitative feedback from customers aged 18 to 30. The survey included questions on shopping frequency, brand perception, price sensitivity, and fashion preferences. In parallel, the team conducted several focus group discussions in three major cities—Jakarta, Kuala Lumpur, and Bangkok—to explore more detailed opinions and emotional responses to the brand. To complement the primary data, the research team also collected secondary data from customer transaction histories, website analytics, and competitor performance reports. They used these to identify patterns in shopping behavior, product categories with declining interest, and how online

engagement compared with in-store visits. During the process, several challenges arose. The online survey had a low response rate until the team introduced a discount coupon as an incentive. In the focus groups, some participants hesitated to criticize the brand openly, so moderators had to adjust their questioning techniques to create a more relaxed environment. Data from different sources also came in different formats, requiring additional time for integration and analysis. The research revealed that younger consumers were increasingly turning to fast-fashion and second-hand platforms that offered trendier styles at lower prices. The retailer's branding was perceived as outdated, and there was a disconnect between what the brand offered and what the target audience expected in terms of both design and social values. Based on the findings, the company introduced a limited-edition youth collection, revamped its marketing tone to reflect sustainability and inclusivity, and expanded its online presence through collaborations with fashion influencers.

Q.4. Attempt all parts of the following: (2×10=20)

- 4(a)** Explain the types of data collection methods used in this case? Identify primary and a secondary method.
- 4(b)** Why do you think the focus groups were important in addition to the survey? Which sampling techniques might have been appropriate for the survey and focus groups?